



TECHNICAL DATA SHEET

QAR179A

PRODUCT DESCRIPTION & USES:

QAR179A is a “Green”, water based Acrylic Adhesive, containing no solvents, clean and easy to work with, with exceptional bond strength and moisture resistance once cured.

Qualichem-Genkem’s QAR179A was developed in conjunction with flooring manufacturers to bond Luxury Vinyl Tiles (commonly referred to as LVT’s, or Vinyl Plank Floor Tiles) to concrete screeds. This type of floor covering is potentially problematic from an installation perspective, because it is prone to expansion and contraction due to temperature variances and excess moisture at the time of installation. For this reason, the adhesive needs fast setting, a reasonable working time, and a very strong glue line when cured. This curing should be achieved within as short a time as possible, preferably in less than 4 hours.

It is imperative that the flooring manufacturer’s specifications and installation instructions be followed, to prevent problems. These generally include 24 hours plus time for acclimatization of the flooring prior to installation, installation at temperatures above 12 degrees centigrade, careful testing for moisture, and if necessary the use of a moisture barrier, and the rolling of the installed flooring with a 68kg, three sectioned roller.

QAR179A very high bond strength minimizes the possibility of planks peaking in the first 24 hours after installation.

GENERAL DATA & CHEMICAL PROPERTIES:

Type	: Acrylic water based
Consistency	: Smooth Paste
Colour	: White
Coverage	: 4 – 5m ² per litre
Shelf Life	: 12 months

SURFACE PREPARATION:

- Concrete screed must be sound, level, smooth, free of dust, loose particles, grease, oils or any contaminants. The screed must be dry and above 12°C, with screed moisture not exceeding that prescribed by the flooring manufacturer.
- Rough or pitted surfaces must be smoothed using a good quality screed levelling or self-levelling compound applied as per the manufacturer’s specifications.
- Slightly damp screeds must be sealed with a high quality moisture barrier, QAR280C and allowed to cure, prior to application of the adhesive.
- If the screed moisture exceeds the specified maximum moisture level (generally this will be less than 3.0%), the screed should either be left to dry until it reaches acceptable levels, or a moisture barrier, such as Qualichem-Genkem’s QAR280C, be applied in two coats.
- If the screed is dusty, the QAR280C can act as a primer to bind the dust. If the screed is excessively dusty, it should first be primed with an appropriate binding agent.

- LVT's should be applied to very smooth surfaces to avoid irregularities showing through later. If necessary a screed smoothing or self-leveling compound should be applied in accordance with the manufacturer's instructions. (If moisture is present, the leveling compound should be applied over the moisture barrier, with the addition of approved binding agents).

APPLICATION:

- Stir well before use.
- Apply evenly with a serrated trowel with 1.5 x 1.5 x 1.5mm V shaped notches, spaced 5mm apart, avoiding pooling. Ensure that the notch sizes are maintained.
- QAR179A has a short open and working time, which is dependent on local and climatic conditions at the time of installation.
- QAR179A is a "wet-stick" adhesive and it is recommended that Qualichem-Genkem preparation and application methods are followed in order to get optimal performance. It is important to roll the installed flooring within 10 minutes, in coastal regions and within 60 minutes in other areas, of adhesive application to ensure proper adhesive transfer onto the back of the planks.
- Proceed with placing the planks into the wet adhesive immediately or so of spreading it.

Note:

QAR179A dries very rapidly to achieve the required bond strength timeously to prevent any dimensional change. This drying and working time is obviously dependent on localized conditions, but is typically between 15 and 20 minutes in coastal regions and between 40 and 60 minutes in other regions. Accordingly we recommend that only sufficient adhesive be applied to enable the laying and rolling of the LVT in this time frame.

A method evolved where large areas are to be installed entails the following:

- Decide the direction the planks are to be laid.
- Chalk line the centre row, and using planks set out a second chalk line 6 planks wide, parallel to the first line.
- Starting at one side, pre-cut planks to size based on pattern, say brickbond, random, etc.
- Spread adhesive from one side, and once enough space is available for laying the planks without interference, lay the planks into the adhesive. Thereafter, two installers can function, opposite each other, laying the planks into the adhesive. At approximately the halfway stage, roll the laid tiles, and wipe off any smudges of adhesive.
- Upon reaching the far side of the spread area, cut in the planks to finish the area.
- Repeat the process, starting at the same side as the first. This is preferable, as the adhesive will have dried sufficiently at this point to prevent movement of the laid planks.
- As an alternative, pour sufficient adhesive from the bucket onto the screed in the area where the flooring is to be installed first, (only use enough to ensure that the flooring can be comfortably accommodated before the adhesive dries too much), and spread the adhesive with a steel notched trowel with serrations of 1.5mm x 1.5mm x 1.5mm with 5mm intervals. The adhesive should be spread evenly, avoiding any pooling.
- The planks must be installed immediately after starting adhesive application, as the adhesive builds up tack very quickly. This enables the installer to optimize his production as the necessity to wait for traditional flash off is not necessary.
- Insert the planks into the adhesive carefully, butting each one gently against the preceding plank. (You do not want the planks butted up too tightly). When the adhered area is complete, roll the floor in all directions with the heavy roller described above. Wipe off any excess adhesive with a damp cloth. If

adhesive is left to dry too long, it may be necessary to use a turpentine based solvent. (Thinners based solvent may dull the wear-layer).

Important:

As mentioned in the note above, the drying and working times of this product are dependent on regional and localized conditions. These include surrounding temperatures and humidity levels. We strongly recommend that you contact our technical staff for more information before commencing any project.

HEALTH AND SAFETY MEASURES:

Water-based Products

This material is essentially non-hazardous; however it is always advisable to keep out of the reach of children and animals, as ingestion may be harmful. Keep the container closed when not in use.

First Aid Measures:

- Eye contact – take care to avoid contact with eyes. In case of contact, immediately rinse the eyes with plenty of water (15minutes) and seek medical advice.
- Skin-contact – if accidental contact with skin should occur, wash the area with soapy water or a recommended skin cleaner.
- Ingestion – (Accidental swallowing) – harmful if swallowed. Drink 3 to 5 glasses of water. Do not induce vomiting. Seek medical advice immediately.

Transportation & Storage:

- This product is NOT classified as Dangerous Goods by Dangerous Goods Code
- Care must be taken to secure product during transportation to avoid spillages.
- Prevent freezing in winter by storing off the ground.

Accidental Spillages:

- Prevent run off into drains and waterways and use absorbent soil, sand or inert material to clean up and collect in container for disposal.

Fire Fighting Measures:

- Specific Hazards – Non-Flammable

Ecological Measures:

- Avoid contaminating drains, sewers, rivers etc.

Material Safety Data Sheet available on request

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Adhesive Problem ... Ask Genkem

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